FabCon Atlanta
2026

Module 3 – Workspace Roles and Item Permissions

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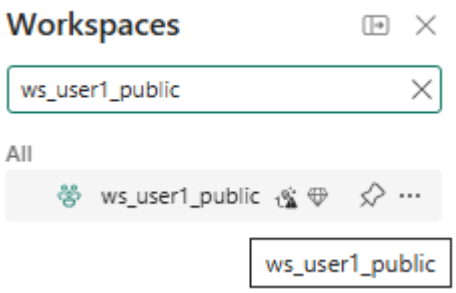
Overview

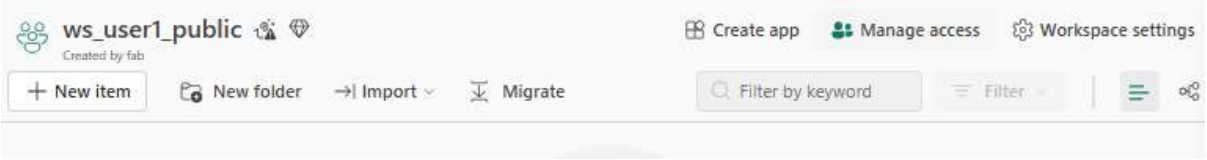
In this exercise, you will use the workspace **ws_<user>_public** to explore workspace roles and item permissions. To observe the impact of these roles and permissions, you will access the workspace using a separate **viewer account**. This viewer account is different from your assigned account; the instructors will provide the viewer account details during the session.

Step 1: Assigning workspace role to a user

1. In Fabric portal, navigate to your workspace ws_<user>_public.

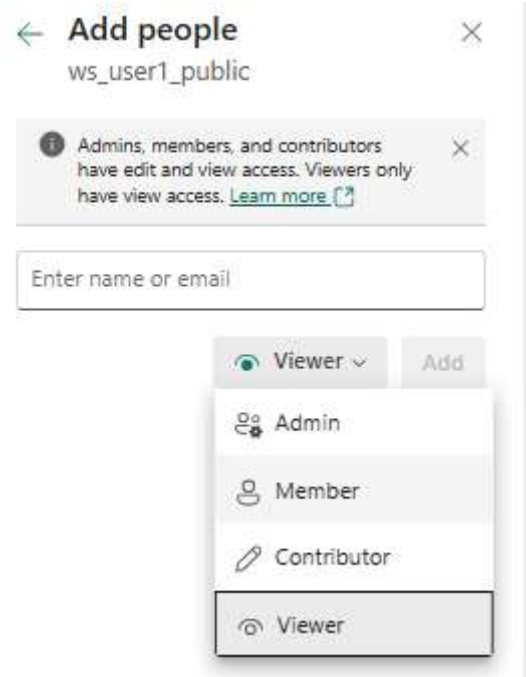


2. Select **Manage Access.**

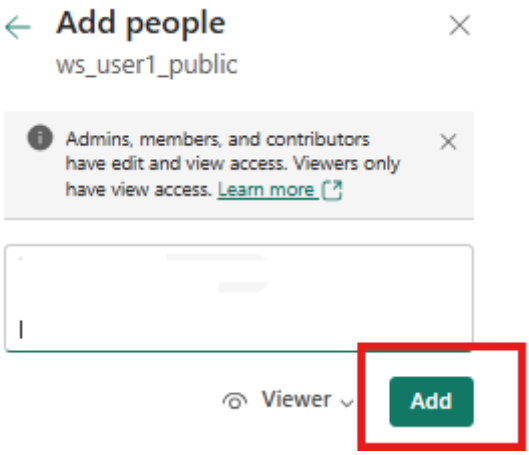


3. Select **+ Add people or groups**

4. You can expand drop-down list to show all types of workspace roles available.



5. In the **Enter name or email** field, type <viewer_test@domain> and select **Viewer** role and then select **Add.** This will assign viewer workspace role to user viewer_test. Please speak to the instructor for which viewer account to use.



Step 2: Testing viewer workspace role

6. Open a new browser window in incognito mode, and go to www.fabric.microsoft.com

7. Login as user viewer_test@domain.com

8. You should only be able to view and read the objects in the workspace. If you navigate to **Workspace Settings** or **Manage Access**, you will observe that these are no longer available.

9. Once you have workspace view role, logout of Fabric and close the session.

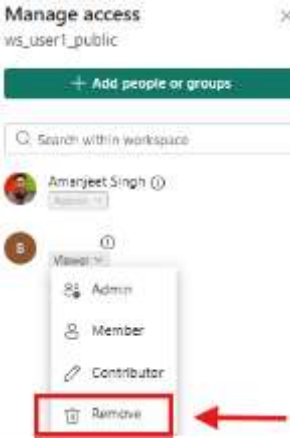
Step 3: Item permissions in Fabric

In a scenario where you do not want to grant workspace-scoped role to a user, you can assign item-scoped permissions to users or security groups. For example, in a workspace which contains many Fabric items (lakehouse, warehouse, reports etc.), instead of assigning a workspace role.

1. Login to https://www.fabric.microsoft.com. Use the username and password provided to you by the instructors.

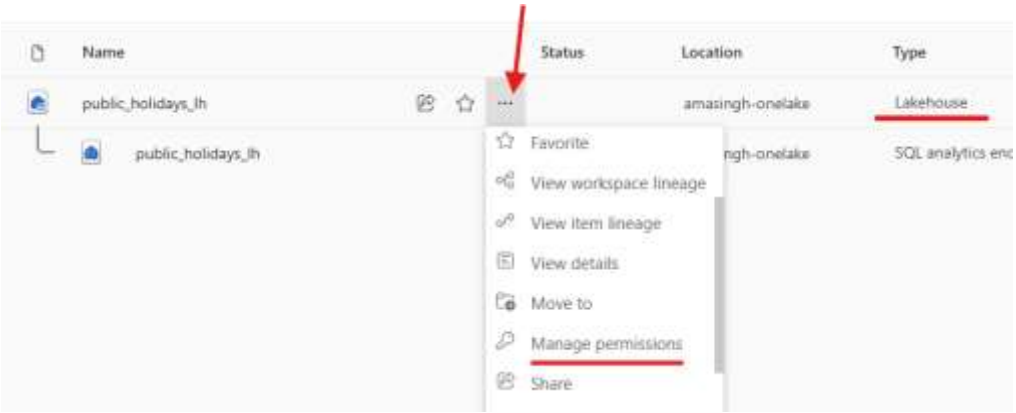
2. Go to the workspace pre-provisioned for this exercise – **ws**_<user>_**public**

3. Open **Manage access** and remove the **Viewer** role from **viewer_test**.

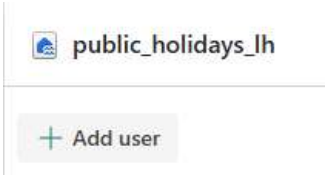


It's important that you remove viewer workspace role assignment as you'll be using the viewer_test user for testing item permissions.

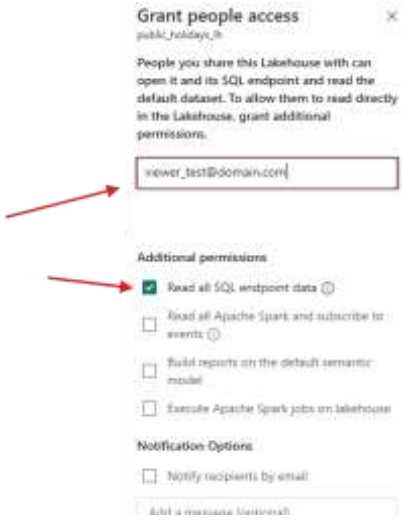
4. In the workspace, locate the lakehouse **public_holidays_lh**, then click ellipses (**...**), and select **Manage Permissions.**



5. Click **+ Add user** to access item-level permissions for lakehouse.

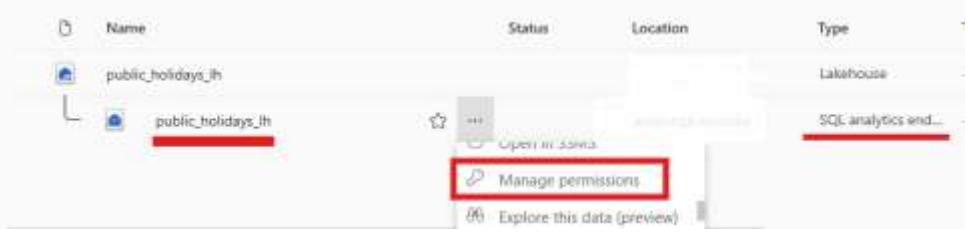


6. In the textbox, add viewer_test@domain.com . In **Additional Permissions**, just select **Read All SQL endpoint data**.



7. Close this dialog box once permission assignment is complete. You should now see this user listed on the screen with **Read** permission.

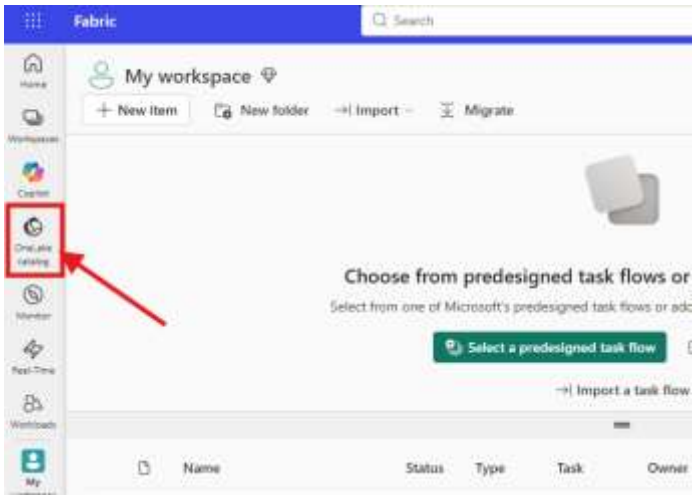
8. To review permissions, select the **ellipsis (...)** next to the **SQL analytics endpoint** and choose **Manage permissions**.



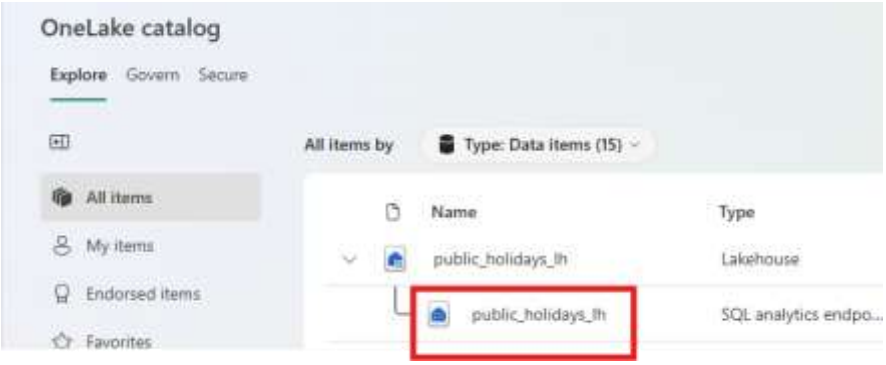
9. Under **Direct Access**, you should see test_viewer listed with Read and ReadData permissions. These permissions were assigned when you granted read access to SQL analytics endpoint.

10. To test the permissions, open a new browser window in incognito mode, and go to www.fabric.microsoft.com, and login as user **test_viewer**

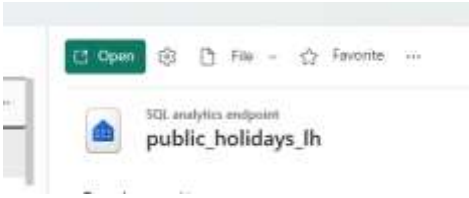
11. Since you do not have any workspace access i.e. workspace role, you need to access the item via **OneLake Catalog.**



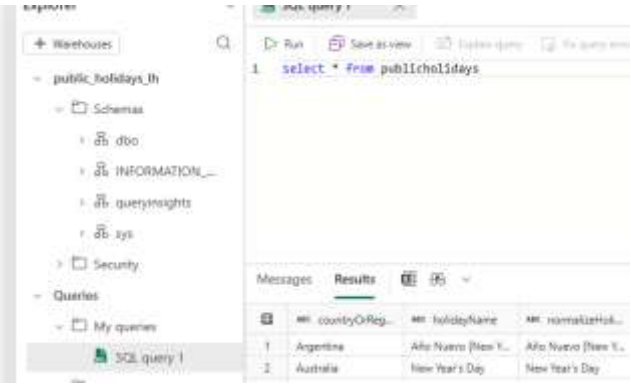
12. In the OneLake Catalog, select the SQL analytics endpoint.
    Note: Even though lakehouse is listed here, you won't be able to access any data via the lakehouse.



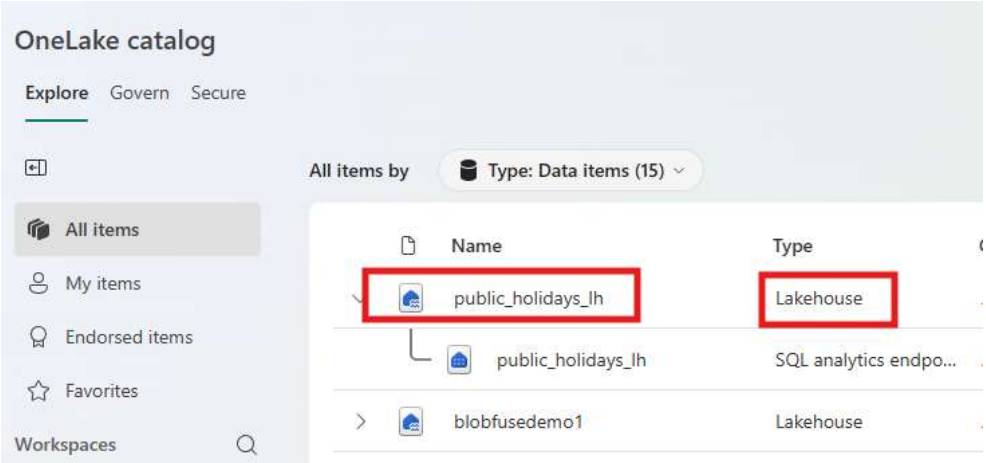
13. Select the **SQL analytics endpoint**, and then select **Open.**



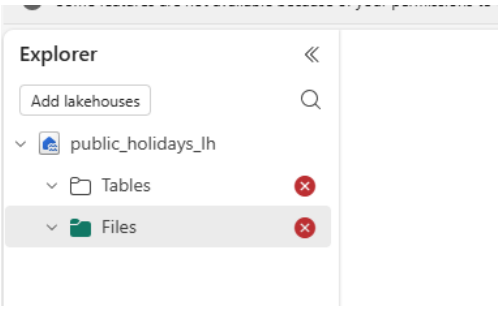
14. In the SQL analytics endpoint, you can run a query and view the results.



15. Stay in this session and as user **viewer_test**, go back to the workspace, and this time, select the lakehouse.



16. Observe that both **Tables** and **Files** are inaccessible. This is expected because no item-level permissions have been granted for direct access to Delta tables in OneLake.



Summary

This completes module 3. In this module, you validated the difference between workspace-level roles and item-level permissions in Microsoft Fabric. You observed how SQL analytics endpoint access does not automatically grant direct access to OneLake tables or files.

This concludes Module 3 – Workspace Roles & Item Permissions.